

Maths Adventure for National Science Week: The Lost Treasure of Coral Bay

Year 1 · National Science Week Special

ACARA V9.0 — AC9M1N04, AC9M1N05, AC9M1N06 (Number: addition and subtraction within 20, mathematical modelling, skip counting and grouping)

Ahoy, Maths Explorer! Captain Ruby's treasure map was torn apart in a wild storm off the coast of Coral Bay! She has found map pieces — but each one is locked behind a maths clue. Solve every clue correctly, crack the final code, and help Captain Ruby find the lost treasure before the tide comes in!

Learning Intention: Students will solve addition and subtraction problems within 20, and use their answers to crack a numerical code.

Warm-Up: Ready Your Sea Legs

$5 + 3 = ___$

$9 - 4 = ___$

$2 + 2 + 2 = ___$

$2, 4, 6, ___, 10$

The Adventure: Solve the Map Clues

CLUE 1 · ADDITION

Captain Ruby found 7 gold coins in one chest and 8 gold coins in another. How many gold coins does she have altogether?

Answer:

CLUE 2 · ADDITION

6 seagulls were flying near the ship. 5 more seagulls joined them. How many seagulls are there now?

Answer:

CLUE 3 · SUBTRACTION

Ruby had 18 coconuts. She gave 6 coconuts to her crew. How many coconuts does she have left?

Answer:

CLUE 4 · REPEATED ADDITION

There are 3 pirates. Each pirate wears 2 hats. How many hats are there altogether?

Answer:

CLUE 5 · MONEY

Ruby has 20 cents. She spends 8 cents on a shiny shell. How many cents does she have left?

Answer: cents

CLUE 6 · TIME

Ruby wakes up at 7 o'clock. She sets sail 2 hours later. What time does she set sail?

Answer:

Unlock the Treasure Chest

Take the **ones digit** from your answers to Clues 1, 2, 3, and 4. Write them in order to reveal the 4-digit lock code!



Clue 1 → Clue 2 → Clue 3 → Clue 4

Challenge: Sharing the Shells

Ruby wants to share 10 seashells equally between herself and 1 friend (2 people in total). How many shells does each person get?

Each person gets:

Bonus Challenge: Ruby's Flag

Ruby's pirate flag is shaped like a triangle. How many sides does a triangle have?

Answer:

Design Your Own Pirate Coin

You found the treasure! Design your own gold coin below and give it a name.

**Case Status**

Clues solved correctly: ____ / 6



Treasure
Found!



So Close — Try
Again

Parent/Teacher Tip: At this age, let your child use fingers, counters, or drawings to work out each clue — physical counting builds the number sense that mental maths later relies on.

For teachers and parents: use this page to check student responses.

Warm-Up Answers

$5 + 3 = 8$ $9 - 4 = 5$ $2 + 2 + 2 = 6$ 2, 4, 6, 8, 10

Adventure Clue Answers

Clue 1: $7 + 8 = 15$ gold coins

Clue 2: $6 + 5 = 11$ seagulls

Clue 3: $18 - 6 = 12$ coconuts

Clue 4: $2 + 2 + 2 = 6$ hats

Clue 5: $20 - 8 = 12$ cents

Clue 6: 7 o'clock + 2 hours = 9 o'clock

Treasure Chest Code

Ones digit of Clue 1 (15) → 5 Clue 2 (11) → 1 Clue 3 (12) → 2 Clue 4 (6) → 6

Final Code: 5 - 1 - 2 - 6

Challenge & Bonus Answers

Sharing the Shells: $10 \div 2 = 5$ shells each.

Ruby's Flag: A triangle has 3 sides.